MATTHEW O'LEARY

Print Production Lead | Prepress, Packaging, Publishing & Large-Format

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Print production leader with 20+ years producing magazines, books, 800+ page catalogs, consumer packaging, and large-format and out-of-home campaigns, from file prep through press. Currently Designer & Production Manager for *California* magazine, taking each issue from layout through press with Quad. Adapt creative across varied media, and build templates, file standards, and AI-assisted InDesign automation that keep complex work consistent and press-ready.

CORE SKILLS

- Production management: Schedules and page flow; editorial, design, and photo coordination; approval cycles; quality control; post-press archiving.
- Prepress, premedia, and print quality: PDF/X preflight; CMYK and Pantone color; image correction; color separations; imposition; proofing and press checks.
- InDesign systems and automation: Templates; parent pages; GREP styles; Data Merge; ExtendScript; AI-assisted tools that build print-ready files from data.
- Large-format and out-of-home: Billboards; truck and bus wraps; building drapes; event booths and signage; directional and wayfinding; vendor specs for bleed, scale, and resolution.
- Publishing: Magazines; books (interiors, covers, spines); retail catalogs; multilingual curriculum; accessible PDFs.
- Packaging: Dielines; spot-color separations; flexo and die-cut; multi-SKU mechanicals; FDA-compliant labels.
- Printer and vendor management: RFQs and job awards; offset, digital, flexo, screen, and large-format printing; proofs and press checks.
- Software: Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Acrobat Pro; Enfocus PitStop; Jira, Trello, Airtable; Figma; Microsoft Office; ChatGPT, Claude.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Designer & Production Manager | *California* Magazine
Aug 2026 – Present | Cal Alumni Association | Remote, Contract

- Own magazine production from layout through press: page flow, ad preflight, image placement, and final files for editorial, advertising, and inserts.
- Manage the printer relationship with Quad, from file delivery and proof approval to press coordination, on a fixed publication schedule.
- Coordinate layout and proof reviews with the Creative Director and Managing Editor. Built the Fall 2026 class notes, obituaries, and masthead from scratch.

Production Consultant & Designer | Matt O'Leary Design
Jan 2010 – Present | Santa Cruz, CA

- Manage production for publishing, packaging, and collateral clients, coordinating print vendors from brief through delivery.
- Develop FDA-compliant packaging mechanicals and product labels.
- Create screen-print color separations for clients including O'Neill Surf Shop.
- Designed *Raw Star Recipes*, a 203-page, full-color cookbook by chef Bryan Au: interior layout, recipe styles, and print-ready files.

Production Support Specialist | OBXtek
Dec 2024 – Oct 2025 | Defense Language Institute contract | Monterey, CA

- Produced long-form foreign-language curriculum in InDesign.
- Standardized templates for 14+ languages and tracked work in Airtable.
- Performed QC and prepared accessible PDFs for government curriculum.

Product Designer → Senior Product Designer | Wiser Solutions, Axway, Kiteworks
Aug 2014 – Mar 2023 | Remote and Palo Alto, CA

- Built template-driven systems and standardized branding across global print and digital campaigns; led a team of designers in a player/coach role.
- Produced production-ready graphics, marketing materials, and design system documentation for software and e-commerce products.

Creative Lead | FastPencil
Oct 2011 – May 2014 | Campbell, CA

- Designed and produced 50+ books: interiors, covers, and full cover spreads with calculated spines, building templates and style hierarchies for each.
- Directed freelance designers and implemented automated production workflows.
- Delivered files to printers, KDP, and IngramSpark with high first-pass rates.

Production Manager | McDill Associates
Sep 2008 – Nov 2011 | Soquel, CA

- Managed print production and designed packaging for national brands including Costco, Martinelli's, and Rainbow Light.
- Built dielines, spot-color separations, and regulated copy for multi-SKU packaging.
- Ran three-vendor RFQs and awarded jobs on price, timing, and quality; coordinated printers and paper suppliers and ran press checks.
- Produced out-of-home and large-format work, including billboards, truck and bus wraps, building drapes, event booths, and directional signage for trade shows like PMA.

Prepress Manager | West Marine
Jan 2002 – Aug 2008 | Watsonville, CA

- Managed prepress for 800+ page national retail catalogs, including preflight, color management, pagination, imposition, and proofing.

- Adapted catalog creative into billboards, truck wraps, event booths, and store signage, preparing files to each vendor's large-format specs.
- Coordinated print vendors and ran press checks at Midwest printers.

Co-founder | The Juice Surf Magazine
1994 – 2000 | Santa Cruz, CA

- Co-founded and ran an independent quarterly surf magazine, producing about 20 issues from editorial through print.

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz
Coursework in Art, Design & Visual Studies
San Jose State University
Coursework in Graphic Design